

IAS MAINS 2020

VALUE ADDITION

GS - I

GS - II

GS - III

GS - IV

12 QUESTIONS WITH MODEL ANSWERS

MODULE - 16

GS – I ... INDIAN SOCIETY

- 34 Recently Haryana said that there is substantial improvement in the child sex ratio. How far can this be attributed to the reduction in preference for son in recent times? Examine the reasons for declining preference for son in countries like India and China. (250 Words)
- 35 “The women members in panchayat raj institutions increased substantially, but the tangible outcome is not commensurate with their numbers”. Examine the underlying reasons for this paradox. (250 Words)
- 36 How the empowerment of women in Bangladesh is structurally different in comparison to India as women empowerment in Bangladesh is quite often talked about from the perspective of tangible outcomes? (150 Words)

GS – II ... CONSTITUTION AND POLITY

- 16 “Right to Privacy has been recognized as a fundamental right”. What does this mean to a common citizen? Examine how far the recent Government policies are in tune with protecting the Right to Privacy as a fundamental right. (250 Words)
- 17 Right to Protest is considered a fundamental right. In this context, critically examine the frequent impositions of Section 144 of the Code of Criminal Procedure, which impinges on the fundamental right of Right to Protest. (150 Words)
- 18 From the narrative of the Secularism, examine the fundamental differences in the constitutions of India and Pakistan. (150 Words)

GS – III ... ENVIRONMENT AND DISASTER MANAGEMENT

- 10 “We are living in an unequal and unjust world and we will continue to live so”. How do you interpret the statement in the context of climate change? (150 Words)
- 11 “Linkages among various Sustainable Development Goals necessitate a nexus approach across various sectors”. Discuss. (250 Words)
- 12 What do you understand by Integrated Pest Management? Critically examine its implementation from the Indian perspective. (250 Words)

GS – IV ... ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE

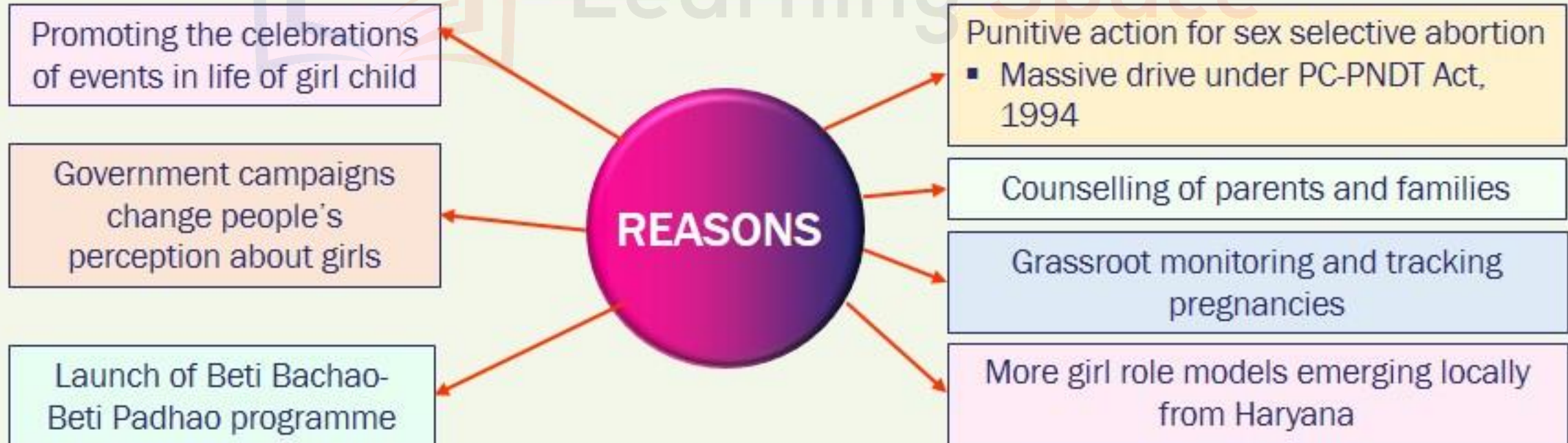
- 46 Discuss the dilemma between preferential treatment and non-discrimination and the way to resolve it. (250 Words)
- 47 Explain the ethical dilemma of profit vs employee welfare. (250 Words)
- 48 Discuss ways to strengthen ethical values in legislature. (250 Words)

34/ IS
GS - I

Recently Haryana said that there is substantial improvement in the child sex ratio. How far can this be attributed to the reduction in preference for son in recent times? Examine the reasons for declining preference for son in countries like India and China. (250 Words)

Haryana has steadily increased its sex ratio from one of the lowest in the country from 833 per 1000 boys in 2011 to 920 in 2019. This can be attributed to multiple Government measures that helped in reducing preference for son.

GOVERNMENT MEASURES



REASONS FOR DECLINING PREFERENCE FOR SON IN COUNTRIES LIKE CHINA AND INDIA

- Spread of market economy has redefined the idea of happiness around material possessions and leisure.
- Focus is now on providing the child with a good education as well as a higher level of consumption which is more likely when there is only one child, irrespective of gender.
- The daughter is more likely to take care of parents.
- Shortage of girls in rural China altered the dynamics of the marriage market.
- Financial ability has replaced family continuity as the marker of the social status.
- Direct talk from leaders like Prime Minister through programmes like “Mann Ki Baat”.
- Failure of One Child Policy in China.
- Visible change of girls achieving greater positions.
- Targeted goal as part of achieving sustainable development goals.
- Convergence among various Government departments provides greater nudge to implement and achieve goals.

CONCLUSION

Change in social norms is as important as economic progress. Law as an agent of change can only have limited success and the need of the hour is disbanding the age old beliefs to embrace gender equal society.



35/ IS
GS - I

“The women members in panchayat raj institutions increased substantially, but the tangible outcome is not commensurate with their numbers”. Examine the underlying reasons for this paradox. (250 Words)

Article 243 D of Constitution empowers women as decision makers with 1/3rd of seats reserved for women. Today, fourteen states have 50%-58% representation of women in Panchayat Raj institutions. Despite the increase in number, there is no commensurate change in outcome due to various institutional and social barriers.

REASONS FOR THE PARADOX



MEASURES TO REMOVE THE PARADOX

- Intensive training of women representatives in various leadership roles
- Making the women aware of their powers and functions
- Awareness campaigns to change patriarchal mindset of men
- Increasing the share of reservations for women at panchayat level to 50%
- Enabling 1/3rd reservations for women in Parliament and legislatures
- Caste barriers are to be broken by providing stringent punishments for caste-based discrimination
- Dismantling existing gendered division of labour by renegotiating gender roles

THE WAY AHEAD

As more women aspire to take their rightful place within governance bodies, it is important for all institutions (state, family and community) to respond by bridging necessary gaps. Further, engendering institutional and operational frameworks to place strategic gender interests at core of governance process will result in exploring the potential of panchayats.



36/ IS
GS - I

How the empowerment of women in Bangladesh is structurally different in comparison to India as women empowerment in Bangladesh is quite often talked about from the perspective of tangible outcomes? (150 Words)

The number of working women in Bangladesh increased to 18.6 million in 2017 from 16 million in 2010. Global Gender Gap report (WEF) ranked Bangladesh at 50, and India at 112 in 2020. This talks about the structurally different approach that Bangladesh has considered for women empowerment.

APPROACH TO WOMEN EMPOWERMENT IN BANGLADESH

- Both Government and non-government sectors played proactive role in a collaborative fashion
- Early interventions were made in the field of family planning to reduce fertility
- Micro credit was introduced
- Mobilization of rural women by NGOs in villages to get services
- Women community level workers to provide door step health services
- Intensive awareness campaigns against gender-based violence
- 'Reserve quota' to help increase number of women in judiciary, administrative jobs, defense and UN peace keeping missions

CONCLUSION

Mobility and availability of opportunities are extremely important for women and girls to strengthen their position among working population. India has to embark on multi-sectoral reforms to realize such structural change.

“Right to Privacy has been recognized as a fundamental right”. What does this mean to a common citizen? Examine how far the recent Government policies are in tune with protecting the Right to Privacy as a fundamental right. (250 Words)

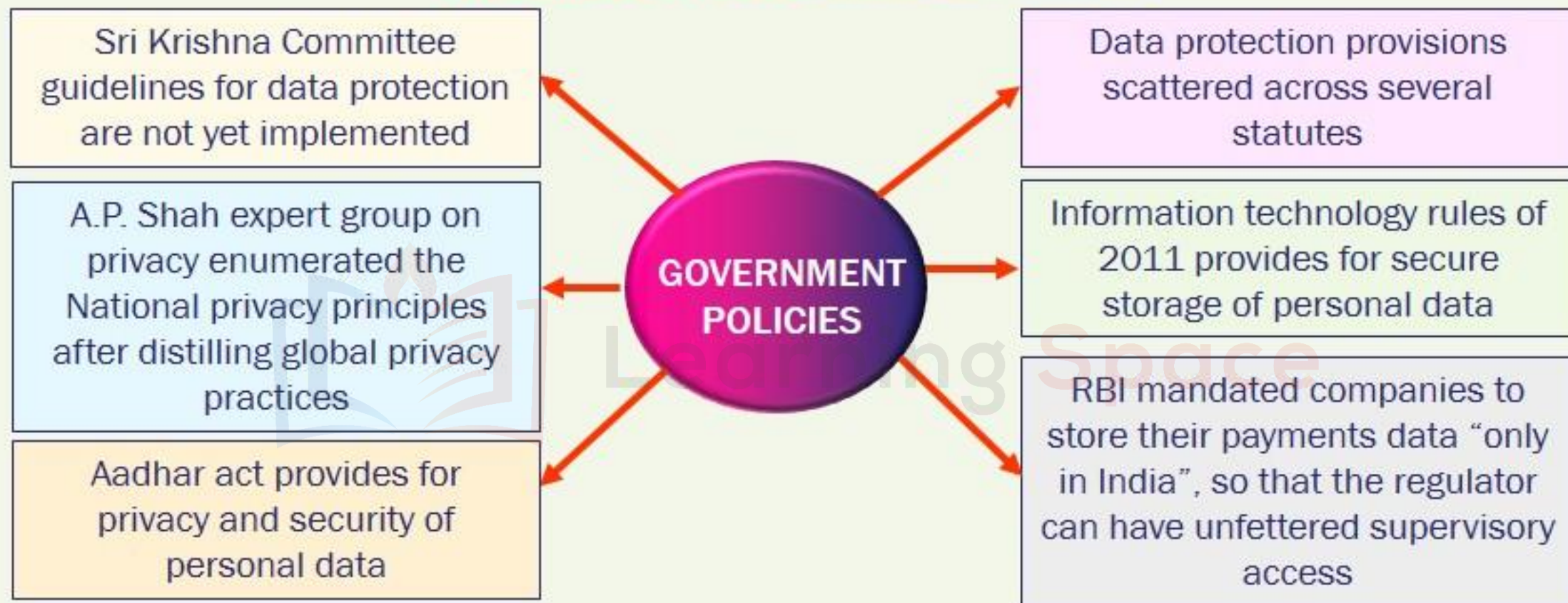
Puttaswamy Vs Union of India judgement declared privacy as intrinsic to life and liberty and an inherent right protected by Part III of the Constitution.

ITS MEANING TO A COMMON MAN

- Can directly approach the Supreme Court and High Courts for violation of the right
- As privacy is made intrinsic to life and liberty under Article 21, it is not just the citizen, but anyone can move the constitutional courts under Article 32 and 226.
- Privacy is made an essential ingredient of other fundamental rights for dignified existence subject to reasonable restrictions.
- Armed the common man against unreasonable state intrusions.
- Provides informational privacy in a digital age.
- Need of consent to collect sensitive data.
- Right to get sensitive data deleted from concerned authorities.
- Control on state passing on personal data to private players.



READINESS OF GOVERNMENT POLICIES



CONCLUSION

Enacting and implementing a stringent data protection law is necessary. The law should make privacy safeguards technology neutral and to apply to both government and private sectors.

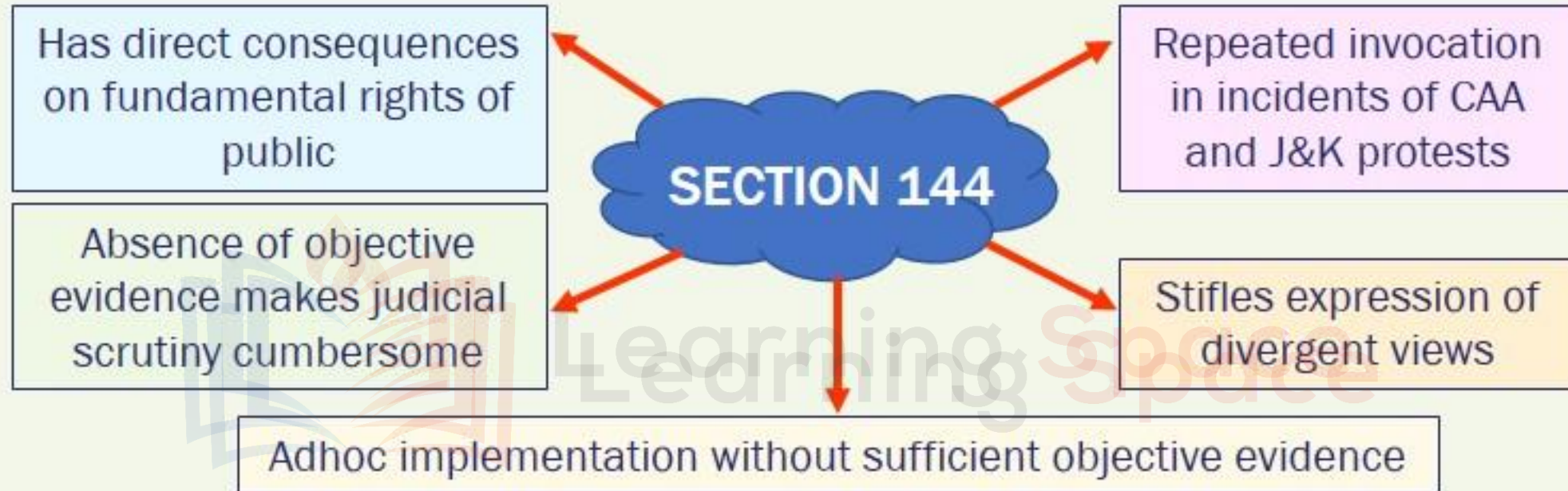
Right to Protest is considered a fundamental right. In this context, critically examine the frequent impositions of Section 144 of the Code of Criminal Procedure, which impinges on the fundamental right of Right to Protest. (150 Words)

Section 144 of Code of Criminal Procedure bars assembly of five or more persons at a place. Recently Supreme Court ruled that Section 144 which restricts citizen's fundamental right to assemble peacefully can't be invoked to prevent legitimate expression of opinion or grievance.

NEED OF SECTION 144



MISUSE OF SECTION 144



THE WAY FORWARD

While exercising the power, it is imperative for the State to balance the rights and restrictions based on principles of proportionality and thereafter apply the least intrusive measure.

From the narrative of the Secularism, examine the fundamental differences in the constitutions of India and Pakistan. (150 Words)

While Indian Constitution was enacted in 1950, Pakistan's Constitution was ratified in 1973. The two constitutions differ significantly on the theme of secularism.

DIFFERENCES ON SECULARISM

SUBJECT	PAKISTAN	INDIA
NATURE	Establishes as Islamic republic	Establishes as secular republic
PREAMBLE	Begins with an invocation of "Almighty Allah"	Rejected any reference to God
MINORITIES	Promises adequate provisions to safeguard minorities interests	More compact as it encapsulates but doesn't explicitly mention, the rights of minorities

IAS MAINS 2020 - VALUE ADDITION

SUBJECT	PAKISTAN	INDIA
FREEDOM OF PRESS	Specifically mentions this freedom but subject to "glory of Islam"	Freedom of Press is part of Freedom of Speech and Expression under Article 19 (1) (a)
FREEDOM OF SPEECH	Regressive and abusive blasphemy law that carries mandatory death penalty	Such abusive laws are absent
FREEDOM OF RELIGION	Conditional and available only to citizens	Fundamental right of all
ELECTIONS	Muslim candidates should have adequate knowledge of Islam	No such requirement to know religious texts to any contesting candidate

CONCLUSION

Pakistan envisaged by Jinnah was a liberal and democratic nation state with equal rights for all citizens rather than the present orthodox Islamic state. Indian constitution upheld the spirit of secular nation envisioned by freedom struggle.



“We are living in an unequal and unjust world and we will continue to live so”. How do you interpret the statement in the context of climate change? (150 Words)

Adverse impacts of climate change that is driven by industrialized nations are being borne by the vulnerable sections and nations who have no major role in climate change process. This makes the world unjust and unequal.

UNJUST AND UNEQUAL – CLIMATE CHANGE

- Island nations being submerged due to rise in sea levels.
- Small nations and least developed economies are worst affected from frequent and uncertain disasters.
- Major contributors to climate change like USA stepping out of treaties like Paris Agreement.
- Implementation of Common But Differentiated Responsibilities under Kyoto is in dilemma.
- Within nation the poorer, weaker sections are the worst affected by disasters.
- Luxury goods like face creams etc. affecting livelihoods of fisherman by reducing fish catch because of microbead pollution in oceans.

THE WAY AHEAD

Coordinated approach towards climate across the nations is necessary. Enlightened self-interest where well being of one nation lies in well being of the entire world should guide International environment dialogues.



“Linkages among various Sustainable Development Goals necessitate a nexus approach across various sectors”. Discuss. (250 Words)

Sustainable development goals (SDGs) aim at lifting people out of poverty by ensuring that development is both socially and environmentally sustainable. Achieving the goals need “nexus” approach that integrates goals across sectors.

ISSUES WITH SILO APPROACH

- Redundancy of goal targets
- Unrealistic goals without mutual coordination across departments
- Experience of failure in achieving Millennium Development Goals
- Results in unsustainable Government policies and development choices
 - ✓ **Eg:** Bio-energy development with greater focus on water and land intensive fuels like maize based ethanol
 - ✓ Charging infrastructure for e-vehicles connected to coal based thermal power plants
- Nudge for better implementation process is absent

“NEXUS” AMONG THE DEPARTMENTS



NEED FOR “NEXUS” APPROACH

- Makes SDGs more cost effective and efficient
- Reduces the risk that SDG actions will undermine one another
- Ensures sustainable resource use
- Mutual monitoring targets provide nudge to faster goal achievement
- Removes duplication of activities
- Greater thrust towards participatory approach to achieve SDGs
- Calls for cooperative federalism in implementing the goals
- Ensures active participation of local governance at various levels across departments
- Channelises towards innovate processes to meet the goals

CONCLUSION

Nexus approach calls for convergence among departments and ministries in implementing government schemes aimed at achieving SDGs. Time based targets and feedback mechanism should be integrated with the approach for more efficiency.

What do you understand by Integrated Pest Management? Critically examine its implementation from the Indian perspective. (250 Words)

Integrated Pest Management (IPM) is a process of solving pest problems while minimizing risks to people and environment. It focuses on long-term prevention of pests or their damage through a combination of techniques such as biological control, habitat manipulation, modification of cultural practices and use of resistant varieties.

GOVERNMENT INITIATIVES TOWARDS IPM

- IPM as cardinal principle in overall crop protection program since 1985
- Submission of plant protection and plant quarantine under National Mission on Agricultural Extension & Technology
- Krishi melas to disseminate knowledge of IPM through workshops
- Training modules in IPM for farmers as part of Corporate Social Responsibility

IRRITANTS IN IMPLEMENTATION

- Poor access to genuine agro-chemicals
- Right time of application is absent
 - ✓ Inability to identify the right stage at which spray is recommended resulting in extra sprays
 - ✓ Increases both cost and usage of agro-chemicals
- Prevalence of mono-cropping
 - ✓ Practicing crop rotation can reduce the use of agro-chemicals
- Heavy reliance only on agro-chemicals rather than on multiple methods to control pests

THE WAY AHEAD

State has to collaborate with NGOs and civil society to develop model fields where in-field training is provided. Farmers' participation is the key for success of IPM.

Discuss the dilemma between preferential treatment and non-discrimination and the way to resolve it. (250 Words)

Preferential treatment refers to favorable treatment to a few as against the rest whereas non-discrimination refers to the same treatment to all sections of society. The former promotes the ethical value of compassion, while the latter promotes the ethical value of equality and impartiality. These two are mutually inclusive.

DILEMMA BETWEEN PREFERENTIAL TREATMENT AND NON-DISCRIMINATION

- If the government wants to be compassionate, it has to offer favorable treatment to weaker sections. But, this course of action could vitiate the principle of impartiality.
- Similarly, if a government decides to treat every section impartially, then some disadvantaged section cannot compete with the privileged sections, leading to cornering the fruits of development by only one section of society. This breeds more inequality in society.
- Suppose, a government offers reservation to a particular section of society, then meritorious people in other sections may feel deceived.
- But if such a reservation is not given, then under-privileged sections shall not get those opportunities at all.



This dilemma can be resolved in the following ways:

- ✓ Preferential treatment only for a limited period until the under-privileged sections build their capabilities.
- ✓ Preferential treatment in capacity-building but not in the employment opportunities.
- ✓ Preferential treatment to be assessed against its impact on the society and progressively reducing it.
- ✓ Preferential treatment to a person or family only for a limited number of times and once those limited chances exhaust, that person or family does not get any more preferential treatment.

WAY AHEAD

Awareness and progressive political attitudes have to be enabled among citizens to streamline preferential treatment to reach the deserved sections and ensure non-discrimination in long term.



Explain the ethical dilemma of profit vs employee welfare. (250 Words)

Since employees are working for the organisation, they are in fact responsible for the profits made by the private institution. They deserve to be paid handsomely, sometimes even a share in profit. They also deserve to be provided with other welfare benefits. Provision of welfare benefits to employees involves cost.

Ethical Dilemma: Should the institution invest in employee welfare? or should the institution exercise restraint in promoting employee welfare so that profit is increased and interest of shareholder is promoted?

- Investment in employee welfare is ethical because of the following reasons:
 - ✓ A happy and healthy employee is an asset to institution. He/she shall bring in fresh ideas and work hard to improve the performance of the organization. It directly increases profits. Thus, it is promoting the interests of shareholders as well.
 - ✓ Wealth generated by the collective effort of many should not be appropriated by a few handfuls. This amounts to injustice against those employees. Hence, investing in employee welfare would do good for this injustice.



- Not investing much in employee welfare is ethical because of the following reasons:
 - ✓ Because employees are already being paid salaries for their work.
 - ✓ It militates against the interests of shareholders.
 - ✓ Employees have not invested any money into the business. Hence, they should be paid to their work, but not as if they invested money as well.

This dilemma can be resolved by following ways:

- Provision of welfare benefits by means of partial contribution by employees themselves. For example, provision of health insurance, premium being shared by employee and employer.
- Provision of shares to employees in the form of sweat equity. Accordingly, employees become owners of the private institution. Then, they would get a portion of profit. This would help them take care of their own welfare.
- Reserving and investing a portion of profit for employee welfare. Returns on this investment should be exclusively used for employee welfare.

CONCLUSION

Enlightened capitalism that includes the prosperity of all stake holders in its success has to guide corporate governance.



Discuss ways to strengthen ethical values in legislature. (250 Words)

Legislatures have become the site of obstruction of legislative process, horse trading, using abusive language and stalling the welfare of citizens. Ethical values in legislature can overcome these irritants to make laws on people's welfare.



STRENGTHENING ETHICAL VALUES IN LEGISLATURE

- Strict prohibition on the usage of foul language against fellow legislators.
- Parliamentary privileges must be revisited to ensure that the legislators do not take shelter under the same for the unethical acts in the premises of Legislature or Parliament.
- Proceedings on criminal and corruption cases must be expedited so that erring legislators do not take advantage of protracted judicial process to stay in power. This can be done in two ways:
 - ✓ Separate exclusive benches to hear cases against legislators; or
 - ✓ A directive to all courts by Supreme Court that cases against legislators must be heard and disposed in the quickest possible time.
- Defection of legislators to other parties either alone or 'en masse' for personal gains should be prohibited. And the proceeding about the intent of defection must be heard and disposed off as soon as possible
- There should be a separate bench to hear election offences petitions. And the proceedings should be fast-tracked and those found guilty of election offences should be debarred from contesting in subsequent elections.

CONCLUSION

Representatives in legislatures reflects the wisdom of people who elected them. Ensuring ethical conduct is necessary not only for hassle free law making but also preserving the trait of matured democracy.



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